



Delaware County Council Meeting March 28th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=q2Gwq8FXmGs
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: March 28, 2023

Body: Delaware County Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer President Piper called the regular meeting of the Delaware County Council to order at [00:04:57](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Council Members Mitch Flanagan, Dan Hughes, Matt Cantz, Jane Lassiter, President Piper, Tommy Webb, and Eugene Whitehead.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Piper.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Donna [00:05:05](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- **00:06:51** Approval of the February 28 council meeting minutes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call (Lassiter abstained).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:33 Agenda Amendment:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** President Piper.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to amend the agenda to place the salary ordinance reading after the transfer and appropriation agenda due to an update received the prior day.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call.
- **00:07:21 Transfer & Appropriation Agenda (General, Auditor, Ball Brothers, VOA, Highway, ARP, Homestead):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tanya / Finance Committee (Dan, Matt, Bill).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine line-item transfers and backfilling employee accounts resulting in a net-zero impact across multiple funds (County General Family Support, Auditor, Ball Brothers Grant, Opioid Grant, Process Capacity Building Grant, Local Highway, ARP Coronavirus Recovery Fund, Eligible Homestead Auditor, CFDA Voca Grant, and Highway Department).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** All individual transfer items were approved by separate roll call votes (Passed Unanimously / Approved by Voice Vote where noted via roll call).
- **00:19:16 Financial Tab: Communications (911) Transfer & Lateral Incentive:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred Cummins, 911 Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a lateral transfer/stipend of \$20,000 to attract experienced 911 communications staff via a \$5,000 signing bonus. Council discussed training costs versus retention risks and the set policy approved by Attorney John Brook.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call.
- **00:24:47 Prosecutor's Office Salary Adjustments, Stipends, & Operating Expenses:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Hoffman, Prosecuting Attorney.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Intensive discussion regarding an appropriation of \$129,688 for Deputy Prosecutor salary increases (\$10,698 per deputy), transcripts, witness fees, legal services, and stipends. Hoffman emphasized a critical staffing shortage, high local homicide rates, and an inability to remain competitive with surrounding counties, citing statutory duties under IC 33-39-6-2(h). Council members expressed support for the office's public safety role but debated the timing outside of budget season and the structure of the requested stipends.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**

- Salary increases and operating expenses: Failed by Roll Call (Webb and Whitehead voted no due to timing/stipends).
 - *(Note: Subsequent related votes for Title IV-D and Prosecutor LIT salary adjustments also failed or split similarly due to the stipend components).*
- **00:09:59 Prosecutor High-Tech Crime Unit:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$7,000 from Ball Brothers grant funds into computers and equipment.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call.
- **00:02:50 Commissioner's EDIT Plan Appropriation:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Brook, County Attorney, and Sarah Hodges.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual \$4,000,000 appropriation of EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) funds to pay bonds and fund operations under the current three-year plan (running July 1, 2022, to June 30, 2025).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call.
- **01:05:02 CASA Advertising & Recruiting:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** CASA Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$3,000 for line item 332 (advertising and recruiting).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call.
- **01:06:20 Ordinance 2023-010: Salary Ordinance Amendment (Highway & Part-Time Rates):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ben (County Attorney) / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Updating the consolidated part-time salary ordinance to explicitly separate non-CDL highway positions (\$14/hour) and CDL-required/equipment operator positions (\$18/hour). Additional amendment to remove the word "Indiana" from high school equivalency requirements to broaden applicant eligibility.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Unanimous consent granted; adopted as amended by Roll Call.
- **01:19:26 Board Appointment <U+2013> 911 Board:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appointment of Council Member Matt Cantz to the 911 Board.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:46:10 Rick Answer:** Spoke regarding taxpayer concerns over rising property tax assessments, tax districts (specifically Yorktown), the county's accumulated cash balance

of \$82 million as of December 31, and noted upcoming public assemblies for transgender youth and adults at the county building.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Auditor Retirement Recognition:** The council and staff honored retiring employee Donna for her decades of service, noting a successful discovery of \$90,198.09 in dormant inheritance tax funds transferable to County General.
 - **Coroner Update:** Gavin Green reported 143 cases year-to-date, improved paperless tracking (~80%), and upcoming MOUs with local law enforcement/EMS.
 - **Economic Development:** Brad Bookow and John Brook provided an update on repurposing the county rail spur via a lease-to-purchase agreement with Smyrna Ready Mix (SMR), involving a \$9.5 million taxable investment, 10<U+2013>15 new jobs, and early bond payoff savings.
 - **Council Rules Committee:** Jane Lassiter and Eugene Whitehead reminded members that survey feedback regarding council rules is due by April 15, 2023.
 - **Next Meeting:** Scheduled for Tuesday, April 25, 2023, at 9:00 AM.
 - **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn made by Jane Lassiter, seconded by Dan Hughes, and approved by voice/roll call vote at the conclusion of the session [01:48:48](#).
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